

031. Chapter 3 Verses 16-18

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 3.16

एवं प्रवर्तितं चक्रं नानुवर्तयतीह यः ।
अघायुरिन्द्रियारामो मोघं पार्थ स जीवति ॥ 16 ॥

evam pravartitam cakram
nānuvartayatīha yaḥ |
aghāyurindriyārāmo
mogham pārtha sa jīvati ||

evam – thus; pravartitam – set in motion; cakram – wheel; na – not;
anuvartayati – follows; iha – in this world; yaḥ – who; agha-āyuh – living in sin;
indriya-ārāmaḥ – rejoicing in the senses; mogham – in vain; pārtha – O Partha;
saḥ – he; jīvati – lives.

The man who does not follow the cycle thus set revolving is a sinner rejoicing in sense-pleasures and he lives in vain.

VERSE 3.17

यस्त्वात्मरतिरेव स्यादात्मतृप्तश्च मानवः ।
आत्मन्येव च सन्तुष्टस्तस्य कार्यं न विद्यते ॥ 17 ॥

yastvātmaratireva syād
ātmatr̥ptaśca mānavaḥ |
ātmanyevā ca santuṣṭas
tasya kāryam na vidyate ||

yaḥ – who; tu – but; ātma-ratiḥ – rejoicing in the Self; eva – only; syāt – may be;
ātma-tr̥ptaḥ – satisfied with the Self; ca – and; mānavaḥ – a man; ātmani – in the
Self; eva – only; ca – and; santuṣṭaḥ – contented; tasya – his; kāryam – duty/
work; na – not; vidyate – exists.

**But he who rejoices, who is contented, who finds happiness
in Atma only, has no work to perform.**

VERSE 3.18

नैव तस्य कृतेनार्थो नाकृतेनेह कश्चन ।
न चास्य सर्वभूतेषु कश्चिदर्थव्यपाश्रयः ॥ 18 ॥

naiva tasya kṛtenārtho
nākṛteneha kaścana |
na cāsyā sarvabhūteṣu
kaścidarthavyapāśrayaḥ ||

◆ na – not; eva – certainly; tasya – his; kṛtena – by action performed; arthaḥ – use/interest; ◆ na – not; akṛtena – by action not performed; iha – here; kaścana – any; ◆ na – not; ca – and; asya – his; sarva-bhūteṣu – in all beings; ◆ kaścit – any; artha-vyapāśrayaḥ – dependence for any object.

For him, there is in this world no interest whatsoever by work done or not done. He does not depend upon any being for any object.